

Midweek Meeting Audience Answers - August 31-September 6, 2026

Midweek Meeting Audience Answers — Week of August 31-September 6, 2026

Life and Ministry Meeting | Jeremiah 31 | Congregation Bible Study: wcg Chapter 6

Audience-style answers. Each answer is written as a short comment that can be given from the audience.

Spiritual Gems

Jeremiah 31:15 — What are the possible fulfillments of this prophecy? (it “Ramah” No. 1 ¶3)

- Answer option 1:** One fulfillment seems connected with the exile. Ramah may have been a place where Jewish captives were gathered before being taken to Babylon. So Rachel, as a symbolic mother of Israel, is pictured as weeping over her children because they were being taken away. But Jehovah later promised comfort and a return, so the prophecy also carried hope.
- Answer option 2:** Matthew 2:17, 18 applies this prophecy to the time when Herod had young boys killed near Bethlehem. So the prophecy had another fulfillment in the deep grief caused by that tragedy. What comforts me is that Jehovah noticed that pain. He did not treat it as just history. He recorded it and connected it with his purpose and future hope.
-

More Spiritual Gem Options

#	Verse	What I take away
1	Jer 31:1	Jehovah wants a close relationship with his people, not just outward obedience
2	Jer 31:3	Jehovah’s loyal love can reach discouraged servants from far away
3	Jer 31:4	Jehovah can rebuild what discipline and hardship have broken
4	Jer 31:6	True worship draws people together, not away from one another

#	Verse	What I take away
5	Jer 31:8	Jehovah notices the vulnerable when he gathers his people
6	Jer 31:9	Jehovah leads repentant ones with mercy, not harshness
7	Jer 31:10	Jehovah is a Shepherd who can gather what has been scattered
8	Jer 31:12	Jehovah's blessings refresh his people like a watered garden
9	Jer 31:13	Jehovah can turn mourning into joy
10	Jer 31:16	Jehovah sees tears and can promise that faithful effort is not wasted
11	Jer 31:18	Discipline can help a person become teachable
12	Jer 31:20	Jehovah's compassion is stirred toward repentant ones
13	Jer 31:25	Jehovah refreshes tired and discouraged people
14	Jer 31:29, 30	Jehovah judges each person justly
15	Jer 31:34	Forgiveness is central to the new covenant

Gem 1 — Jeremiah 31:3

Answer option: Jeremiah 31:3 says Jehovah drew his people with loyal love. That means his affection did not disappear just because his people had gone through discipline. He still wanted them back. This helps me see Jehovah as warmly attached to his servants. When someone is discouraged or feels far from him, Jehovah's loyal love can still draw that person close again.

Gem 2 — Jeremiah 31:8

Answer option: I like the detail in Jeremiah 31:8 that Jehovah would gather even the blind, the lame, pregnant women, and mothers. He did not think only of the strong travelers. He noticed the people who would need extra care. That teaches me that Jehovah's restoration is tender and practical. He knows what each servant needs in order to make it home.

Gem 3 — Jeremiah 31:9

Answer option: Jeremiah 31:9 says Jehovah would lead them to streams of water on a straight path where they would not stumble. That gives me a beautiful picture of Jehovah's guidance. He does not just say, "Come back." He helps repentant ones walk safely. In the ministry, that is the kind of Father we invite people to know.

Gem 4 — Jeremiah 31:12

Answer option: Jeremiah 31:12 describes Jehovah's people becoming like a well-watered garden. That image helps me see that Jehovah does more than rescue his servants from danger. He refreshes them and helps them become spiritually alive again. When I feel dry emotionally or spiritually, I want to stay close to Jehovah because he can restore joy and strength.

Gem 5 — Jeremiah 31:16

Answer option: Jeremiah 31:16 says, "Hold back your voice from weeping" because there is a reward for their activity. That is comforting. Jehovah sees tears, but he also sees faithful effort. Sometimes a parent, publisher, or discouraged person may wonder if their effort has been wasted. This verse reminds me that Jehovah can attach a reward to loyal effort that looks painful now.

Gem 6 — Jeremiah 31:20

Answer option: Jeremiah 31:20 is very tender. Jehovah speaks of Ephraim as a precious son and says his compassion is stirred. Even after correction, Jehovah's feelings toward repentant ones are warm. That helps me love him more. He is not cold after discipline. When a person responds, Jehovah's mercy moves toward them deeply.

Gem 7 — Jeremiah 31:25

Answer option: Jeremiah 31:25 says Jehovah will fully satisfy the tired one and replenish everyone who is weak. That is a verse I would want to remember when I feel emotionally worn down. Jehovah does not shame tired servants. He knows how to refresh them. Through his Word, prayer, meetings, and the congregation, he can give strength back.

Gem 8 — Jeremiah 31:34

Answer option: Jeremiah 31:34 says Jehovah would forgive error and no longer remember sin. That shows how complete his forgiveness can be. He does not keep bringing repentant people back to the same failure. The new covenant gives a legal basis for forgiveness, and that makes me grateful for Jehovah's mercy and for Jesus' sacrifice.

Living as Christians — Be Adaptable: Use JW.ORG

Before giving a witness, how could we demonstrate empathy? — James 1:19

Answer option 1: James 1:19 says to be quick to listen and slow to speak. So before giving a witness, I would first acknowledge the person's pain. I might say, "I'm really sorry you went through that. I can understand why that would leave you with painful questions." That kind of response shows that we see the person, not just the objection.

Answer option 2: Empathy would also mean not rushing to correct the person. If he feels abandoned by God, that feeling may come from deep hurt. I could ask a gentle question, such as, "Would you be comfortable telling me what happened?" Listening first may make the scripture we share feel like comfort, not a debate.

What scripture might you share? How would you find that scripture on jw.org?

Answer option 1: I might share Psalm 34:18, which says Jehovah is close to the brokenhearted. To find it on jw.org, I could use the search box and type "brokenhearted" or "God close to brokenhearted." That would help me quickly locate a scripture that addresses the person's feeling of being abandoned.

Answer option 2: I might also share 1 Peter 5:7, which invites us to throw our anxieties on Jehovah because he cares for us. On jw.org, I could search "does God care about me" or "anxiety God cares." The point is to use the website to find a comforting Bible thought that fits the person's pain.

If a scripture does not quickly come to mind, what would you type in the search box to find helpful information?

Answer option 1: I would type simple words close to what the householder said, such as "abandoned by God," "why suffering," "does God care," or "personal tragedy." Simple search terms often work best because they connect with article titles or common Bible questions on jw.org.

Answer option 2: I could also search for the feeling rather than the full issue. For example, "grief," "lonely," "discouraged," or "comfort." That may help me find a Bible-based article or video that speaks to the person's heart, even if I do not remember a specific scripture right away.

If you do not have access to jw.org or JW Library, how would you try to help the householder?

Answer option 1: I would still try to help by listening carefully and sharing a scripture I know from memory, even if it is very simple. I might offer to come back with an article or scripture that answers the question better. That shows humility and concern instead of pretending I have every answer immediately.

Answer option 2: I could also leave the person with a comforting thought and arrange to return. For example, I might say, “The Bible does show that God is not indifferent to our pain. I would like to bring you a scripture that has helped many people.” Then I could prepare and follow up with something specific.

Congregation Bible Study — Chapter 6: Rebekah — She Ventured Into the Unknown

In what ways did Rebekah show courage?

Answer option 1: Rebekah showed courage first by showing hospitality to strangers. She did not know Eliezer or his men, but she willingly helped them and watered the camels. Later, she showed even greater courage by agreeing to leave her family and travel far away to marry Isaac, a man she had never met, because she recognized Jehovah’s direction.

Answer option 2: I think Rebekah’s courage was practical. She did not just say she had faith; she acted. She ran to draw water, welcomed strangers, listened to evidence of Jehovah’s direction, and then said, “I am willing to go.” That teaches me that courage often shows in quick, willing action when Jehovah’s will becomes clear.

Dig Deeper

1. How was Eliezer affected when Abraham had children, but what indicates that he was not resentful? (Gen. 15:2-4; 24:12; w97 1/1 30 ¶2)

Answer option 1: Before Isaac was born, Eliezer may have been in line to inherit Abraham’s household. But when Abraham had children, that changed. Even so, Eliezer did not show resentment. He faithfully served Abraham and prayed for Jehovah to help him find a wife for Isaac. That shows humility and loyalty.

Answer option 2: What stands out to me is that Eliezer worked hard for the success of someone who had received what he might once have expected. That is a beautiful spirit. He was not focused on what he lost. He was focused on Jehovah’s purpose and on serving faithfully where he had been placed.

2. Why did Abraham want Isaac’s bride to move to Canaan rather than have Isaac move to Rebekah’s hometown? (w97 1/1 30 ¶3)

Answer option 1: Abraham knew that Jehovah’s promise was connected with Canaan. He did not want Isaac to marry a Canaanite, but he also did not want Isaac to leave the land Jehovah had promised. So the bride was to come to Isaac. Abraham was protecting both pure worship and Jehovah’s purpose for Isaac’s family line.

Answer option 2: This teaches me that spiritual decisions should not solve one problem by creating another. Abraham wanted a wife for Isaac from a family that knew Jehovah, but he also wanted Isaac to remain where Jehovah's promise was centered. His decision shows careful faith, not just family preference.

3. What was the significance of the gifts offered to Rebekah and her family? (it "Rebekah" ¶4)

Answer option 1: The gifts were not just ordinary presents. They helped show the seriousness and honor of the marriage arrangement. They confirmed that Eliezer came from Abraham's household and that the proposal was genuine. In that setting, such gifts were part of an honorable arrangement between families.

Answer option 2: I like that the account shows respect and dignity in the arrangement. Rebekah was not treated casually. The gifts, the family discussion, and the question put to Rebekah all show that this was a serious step. Jehovah's direction does not remove dignity from people; it elevates it.

4. Describe the trip Rebekah made from Haran to Isaac's home in the Negeb. (wp16.3 15 ¶1) A

Answer option 1: The trip from Haran to the Negeb was long, about 800 kilometers, and may have taken around three weeks. It likely was not comfortable, especially traveling by camel through difficult terrain. Rebekah left familiar surroundings and family, not for a short visit, but for a new life connected with Jehovah's purpose.

Answer option 2: Picture A helps me appreciate the courage involved. The Negeb could be rugged and very different from home. Rebekah was not moving into ease and certainty. She was entering an unknown assignment. Her willingness reminds me that serving Jehovah may involve discomfort, but Jehovah's direction makes the step worthwhile.

Reflect on the Lessons

What can we learn from Abraham, Rebekah, and Isaac about choosing a marriage mate? (Gen. 24:2, 3; 27:46-28:1)

Answer option 1: We learn that marriage should be guided by worship of Jehovah, not just attraction or convenience. Abraham cared deeply that Isaac's wife not come from the ungodly Canaanites. Rebekah also showed spiritual qualities. The lesson is that the most important question is whether the person will help us keep serving Jehovah.

Answer option 2: Isaac and Rebekah's marriage also shows the value of looking for spiritual qualities. Rebekah was diligent, hospitable, modest, and willing to follow Jehovah's direction. Those qualities mattered more than background or appearance. For Christians, choosing a marriage mate should protect our friendship

with Jehovah and our future worship.

Rebekah was diligent, generous, and respectful. In what ways can sisters imitate her today? B

Answer option 1: Sisters can imitate Rebekah by being willing workers and by noticing practical needs. Rebekah did not do the minimum; she offered more help than was requested. Today, sisters show that same spirit by helping family, supporting the congregation, encouraging older ones, and being generous with their time and energy.

Answer option 2: Rebekah was also respectful and spiritually responsive. Sisters today can imitate her by supporting family worship, speaking respectfully, and being willing to accept Jehovah's direction even when it involves change. Her example shows that courage and modesty can go together beautifully.

Meditate on the Bigger Picture

What does this account teach me about Jehovah?

Answer option 1: This account teaches me that Jehovah can guide important personal decisions. Eliezer prayed, watched carefully, and saw Jehovah's hand in the outcome. Jehovah was interested in the marriage that would affect Isaac and the promised line. That helps me trust that Jehovah also cares about decisions that shape our spiritual future.

Answer option 2: It also teaches me that Jehovah values qualities that people might overlook. Rebekah's beauty is mentioned, but the account highlights her hospitality, diligence, generosity, modesty, and courage. Jehovah notices the inner qualities that make someone useful in his purpose.

How does this account tie in with Jehovah's purposes?

Answer option 1: Rebekah became Isaac's wife and later the mother of Jacob, so her decision was connected with the family line through which Jehovah's promises would continue. Her simple words, "I am willing to go," helped move Jehovah's purpose forward.

Answer option 2: The account also shows that Jehovah's purpose advances through willing individuals. Rebekah was not forced. She chose to cooperate with what she recognized as Jehovah's direction. That reminds me that our willing choices, even private ones, can have a place in Jehovah's larger purpose.

What would I like to ask Rebekah in the resurrection?

Answer option 1: I would like to ask Rebekah what helped her say, “I am willing to go” so quickly. Did she feel afraid about leaving her family? I would love to hear how she recognized Jehovah’s hand and found the courage to step into a completely new life.

Answer option 2: I would also like to ask her about the long trip to the Negeb. What did she think about during those weeks of travel? Did she talk with Eliezer about Abraham, Sarah, and Isaac? It would be encouraging to hear how her faith grew while she was on the way to a future she had never seen.

Verified Source Pages

- Meeting schedule: <https://www.jw.org/en/library/jw-meeting-workbook/july-august-2026-mwb/Life-and-Ministry-Meeting-Schedule-for-August-31-September-6-2026/>
- Book study: <https://www.jw.org/en/library/books/walk-courageously-with-god/patriarchs-to-time-of-judges/rebekah-ventured-into-the-unknown/>